

How to read the live board

JUG, slot 8 · generated Sep 07 2026, 12:59 from the board's own legend — if this disagrees with the screen, the screen is right and this file is stale.

THE ONE RULE. At picks **8, 17, 32, 41 and 56** the board beats its own runner-up by 13.6 / 5.0 / 13.4 / 7.8 / 2.3 points — **take row 1**. From pick 65 the margin falls to 2.5 and then to 0.06: the board cannot separate its top rows, so **you** decide, on the badges, the news on the card, and the Value Ladder. **Pick 32 is a coin flip even at row 1** — more computing does not find a winner there, it just becomes consistent about there not being one.

THE STRIP UNDER THE HEADLINE

QB 1/1 RB 2/2 +1 WR 1/2 TE 0/1 FLEX 1/1	Your NINE starting slots, not your roster size. Green = filled, amber = one short, red = empty.
+n	Bench depth at that position, beyond the slots that start. The left-hand number never goes above the right-hand one, because the right-hand one is how many of that position start — "3 of 2" would mean nothing.
full	You are at this roster's cap for that position; the board will stop offering it.
N skill turns left	How many of your twelve skill picks remain, this one included.
... next turn the board can only offer QB and TE	A warning, one turn early. The engine force-drafts your missing starters when turns run out.
FORCED — only QB and TE from here	It is happening now. Every row on the board is one of those positions until the slot is filled.

THE COLUMNS THAT NEED EXPLAINING

COLUMN	WHAT IT IS
VBD	Season points above a replacement-level starter at his position. The pure "how good is he" number, comparable across positions.
adds now	Points this player adds to your STARTING LINEUP if you take him right now. Lower than VBD when you already have that position filled.
if I wait	What the best player at the same position is expected to add if you skip him and take him at your NEXT turn instead.
wait cost (Δ)	adds now minus if I wait. A tempo number, not the ranking. Big Δ = his position falls off a cliff before your next turn. Small Δ = that position can wait. The list is NOT sorted by this — see cost vs #1.
cost vs #1	This is what orders the list, and it is the only bar on the page — a longer bar means further behind, and a FULL bar means 20 points or more behind, at every pick. Every row is scored by simulating your whole remaining draft after taking him; this column is that score minus row 1's. free = row 1, the recommendation. tie = within 1.5 pts, which is closer than the engine can measure — take whichever you prefer, it costs nothing. Grey = under 6 pts, cheap. Red = it is not cheap.
still there?	Chance he is still on the board at your NEXT turn. 80% = he probably lasts, so you can take someone else first. 10% = now or never. Blank on row 1 — you are taking him now, so it does not apply. goes first = this row is a tie with the recommendation AND at least 20 points less likely to survive to your next turn. It is not an argument that the engine is wrong. The engine already simulates who will be gone, so a tie is a tie <i>after</i> counting that — the mark tells you which of the tied rows you can only get on this turn. Use it when you have something the board does not: a news line on the card, an analyst call, a badge. Deliberately rare — it needs a tie, a 20-point gap, and a player the market actually prices.
the GONE column	The last 14 players taken, newest at the top. NOW is the pick that just happened, then -1, -2 and so on counting back. The top three are brightened. 14 is not a round number. From slot 8 exactly 8 or 14 picks happen between your turns, so this column always holds <i>everything taken since you last picked</i> — and on the long waits (32, 56, 80, 104, 128, 152) it is exactly that window, ending at -13 . It is not trying to replace ESPN's full pick list.
the dashed TIER BREAK line	A real cliff inside the twelve rows on screen — the number is how many VBD points drop across it. The threshold adapts to the spread actually showing, so a flat board draws none. There are always exactly three slots for these lines; when fewer cliffs exist the rest are invisible spacers, which is what stops the page changing height every refresh.
RUN: 4 RB of the last 6	A position run, next to the recommendation. It only fires at 4 or more of the last 6 — three of six is the ordinary state of a 12-team draft, and a warning that is always on is not a warning. Only the position actually running is named.

THE COLOURS IN THAT COLUMN

ON SCREEN	WHAT IT IS
free	Row 1 — the recommendation. It costs nothing because it <i>is</i> the pick.
-0.9 tie	Within 1.5 points. The engine cannot separate this row from row 1 — take whichever you prefer.
-4.2	Under 6 points behind. Cheap, if you have a reason.
-13.7	More than 6 behind, and the bar beside it is long. Not cheap.
RUN: 4 RB of the last 6	Four or more of the last six picks went to one position. Three of six is just a draft, so it does not fire.
QB RB WR TE	The position chip, same four colours everywhere on the page.

THE MARKS BESIDE A NAME

At most **two** judgement marks per row — one caution on the left, one edge on the right. That cap is deliberate. Click any row to open the full card: injury history, the bull and bear cases, the backfield, and any dated news.

MARK	WHERE	WHAT IT MEANS
AVOID	left of the name	The injury sheet grades him AVOID. Do not draft him at this price.
OUT	left of the name	ESPN has him OUT.
IR	left of the name	ESPN has him on injured reserve.
DISC	left of the name	DISCOUNT — worth taking later than this rank, not here.
BYE	left of the name	His bye week collides with someone already on your roster. Worth at most 1.2 points, ever (\$4.11) — never move a pick with real margin behind it.
FADE	left of the name	Analysts called him DOWN and nobody called him up.
MINE	either side	Your own take. It outranks every list on the page — red if you faded him, amber if you like him.
BUY	right of the name	Both analyst panels are ahead of his ADP. Brighter = more independent kinds of evidence agreeing (max 2 kinds: ANALYSTS and ROLE).
CALLS	right of the name	No panel signal, but named analysts targeted him on a podcast.
OPEN	right of the name	He is the direct backup into an UNSETTLED backfield. Only from pick 104.
DART	right of the name	Direct backup, but the job in front of him is settled — only pays on an injury. Only from pick 104.
ok	right of the name	The injury sheet actively cleared him. Stop flinching.
R	after the name	Rookie — no 2025 NFL snaps and not in the 2023 or 2024 player pool. Grey and plain on purpose: a fact, not a rating . Nothing here computes a ceiling.
goes first	in still there?	This row is a TIE with the recommendation AND at least 20 points less likely to survive. It is the one you can only get on this turn.

DRAFT NIGHT, IN ORDER

6:55 PM	draft_night.bat — verifies the file tree, fetches the actual keepers, rebuilds the board, re-injects the prerank.
7:50 PM	py bridge_server.py FIRST, then open the draft room in Chrome with the espn_bridge extension loaded.
7:55 PM	py live_draft.py --bridge — check the first poll line reports the keeper-row count.
8:00 PM	Draft. The board refreshes itself; you never reload it.
if it looks wrong	The board is always 12 player rows and 3 dashed tier lines . Any other count means something is broken — say so, do not explain it away.